Data Management Planning in the Social Sciences in the UK

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OVERVIEW

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§1 POLICIES ON DATA SHARING

§1.1 Funder policies on data sharing

- Increasingly research funders require data management and sharing planning - mandate or encourage data sharing

- UK research councils requiring data management plans
  - AHRC
  - BBSRC
  - ESRC
  - MRC
  - NERC
  - The Wellcome Trust

  Source:
  www.dcc.ac.uk/resources/policy-and-legal/overview-funders-data-policies

References: [1] to [5]

§1.2 RCUK shared principles

RCUK Common Principles on Data Policy

Key messages:

1. Data are a **public good**
2. Adherence to community **standards and best practice**
3. **Metadata** for discoverability and access
4. Recognise constraints on **what data** to release
5. Permit **embargo periods** delaying data release
6. Acknowledgement of / compliance with **T&Cs**
7. Data management and sharing activities should be explicitly **funded**

http://www.rcuk.ac.uk/research/Pages/DataPolicy.aspx

§1.3 ESRC research data policy

- ESRC research data policy revised in 2010 [2]
- Since May 2011, DMPs are required for all applications where data will be created
- Data must be offered to UK Data Archive when research ends (via Economic and Social Data Service)
- DMPs should include or cover:
  - assessment of existing data;
  - information on new data;
  - quality assurance of data;
  - back-up and security of data;
  - expected difficulties in data sharing;
  - copyright/Intellectual Property Right;
  - responsibilities;
  - preparation of data for sharing and archiving.

§1.4 Funding application process

- All UK RCs use the Je-S form for grant applications, as do the Technology Strategy Board and the Energy Technologies Institute
- ESRC require a DMP as mandatory attachment (max 3 pages)
- DMPs are reviewed by peers as an integral part of grant application
- ESRC plan to revisit the applicant and reviewer experiences after a few months

§2 ARCHIVES, SUPPORT SERVICES AND TOOLS

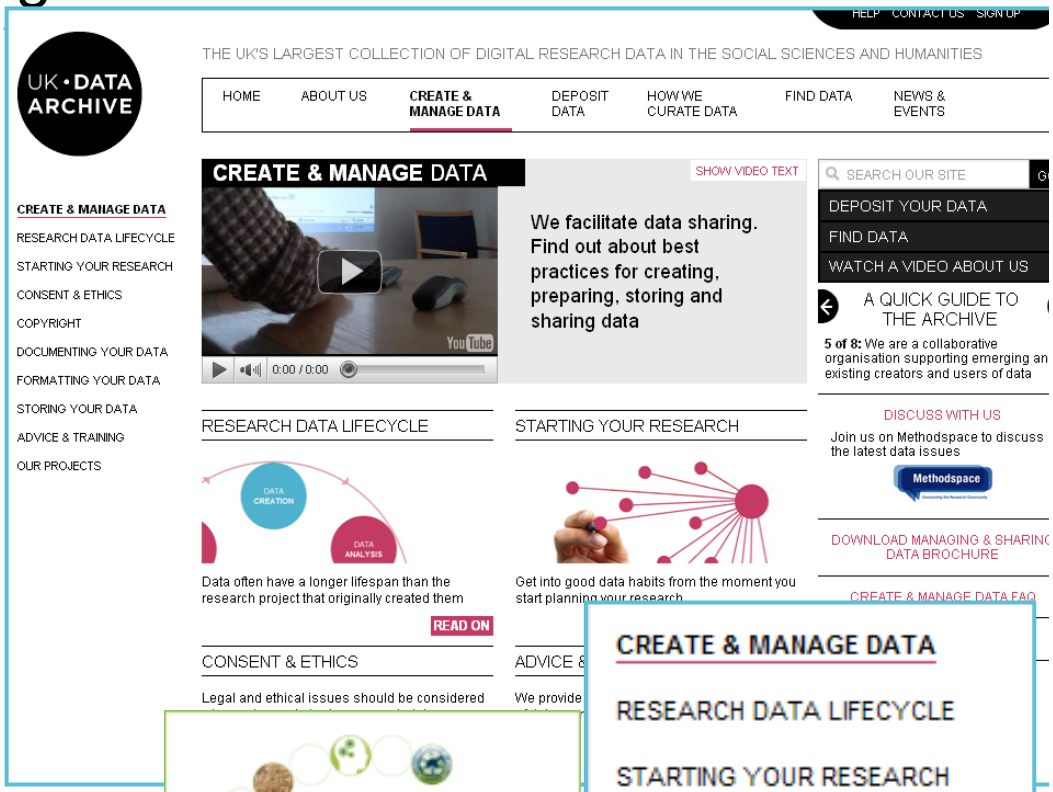
§2.1 UKDA: supporting social science researchers

- Online data management and sharing guidance for social sciences

  3500 hits/month [6]
- Managing and Sharing Data - best practice for researchers

  3400 distributed to date [7]
- ESDS guidance for preparing DMPs [8]
- Training workshops on various data management topics

  300 participants since 2008



§2.2 DCC: support for all

- Policy monitoring
- Data management planning resources: Checklist [9], DMP Online [10], guidance...
  - As of yesterday, there are 451 plans on the system, of which 82 have ESRC as funder (2nd highest share)
- Regional data management roadshows
- DC101 training courses (with UKDA contributions)
- How-To guides and other publications

§3 PRACTICE: PLANS AND PROCEDURES, OPERATIONALISATION AND MONITORING

§3.1 Recent discussions

- Moving towards a more formal relationship where RCs have increased ownership of the way they are portrayed in DMP Online: mappings, guidance [11], endorsement
- Ongoing dialogue between ESRC, RCUK, UKDA, ESDS and DCC about data policy and DMPs
- Streamlining of processes and systems

§4 CONCLUSION: INTEGRATION AND COLLABORATION, IN THE UK AND BEYOND

§4.1 Integration

- Data policy streamlining
- UK Data Archive developing DMP guidance for applicants and for reviewers for ESRC (also being built in to DMP Online tool) [11]
- JISC call for projects to link DMP Online with institutional admin/funding systems, CRISs, etc...

§4.1 Collaboration

- DCC-RIN Research Data Management Forum
- Unconference session on reviewing DMPs at recent JISC international workshop with representation from funders: share real DMP experiences of BBSRC, Relu and CEH
- Crowdsourcing of DCC Checklist
- International collaborations (USA, Australia...)

§5 REFERENCES

Numbered in slides:

- [1] Biotechnology and Biological Sciences Research Council (2010) *BBSRC data sharing policy*. URL: www.bbsrc.ac.uk/organisation/policies/position/policy/data-sharing-policy.aspx
- [2] Economic and Social Research Council (2010) *ESRC research data policy*. URL: www.esrc.ac.uk/about-esrc/information/data-policy.aspx
- [3] Medical Research Council (n.d.) *MRC policy on data sharing and preservation.* URL: www.mrc.ac.uk/Ourresearch/Ethicsresearchguidance/Datasharinginitiative/Policy/index.htm
- [4] Natural Environment Research Council (2011) *NERC data policy*. URL: www.nerc.ac.uk/research/sites/data/policy.asp
- [5] Wellcome Trust (2010) *Wellcome Trust policy on data management and sharing*. URL: www.wellcome.ac.uk/About-us/Policy/Policy-and-position-statements/WTX035043.htm
- [6] UK Data Archive. *Create and manage data.* URL: www.data-archive.ac.uk/create-manage
- [7] Van den Eynden, V., L. Corti, M. Woollard, L. Bishop and L. Horton, L. (2011) *Managing and sharing data - best practice for researchers.* 3rd edition. Colchester, UK Data Archive, University of Essex. URL: www.data-archive.ac.uk/media/2894/managingsharing.pdf
- [8]Economic and Social Data Service (2011) *Data management plan guidance.* http://www.esds.ac.uk/create/esrc/dataman/
- [9] Donnelly, M. and S. Jones (2011) *Checklist for a Data Management Plan, v3.0.* URL: http://dmponline.dcc.ac.uk/system/attachments/8/original/DCC_Checklist_DMP_v3_md_sj.pdf?1300724157
- [10] Donnelly, M., S. Jones and J. W. Pattenden-Fail (2010) *DMP Online: the Digital Curation Centre's web-based tool for creating, maintaining and exporting Data Management Plans*, International Journal of Digital Curation, Vol 5, No 1. URL: http://www.ijdc.net/index.php/ijdc/article/view/155/218
- [11] Economic and Social Research Council (2011). *Data management plan: guidance for peer reviewers.* URL: www.esrc.ac.uk/_images/DMP%20Guidance%20for%20Peer%20reviewers_tcm8-15569.pdf

See also:

- Donnelly, M. and R. North (2011*) The Milieu and the MESSAGE: Talking to Researchers about Data Curation Issues in a Large and Diverse e-Science Project*, International Journal of Digital Curation, Vol 6, No 1. URL: http://www.ijdc.net/index.php/ijdc/article/view/161/229
- Van den Eynden, V. et al. (2010) *Data Management Practices in the Social Sciences*, UK Data Archive (UKDA) http://www.data-archive.ac.uk/media/203597/datamanagement_socialsciences.pdf

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